

Emergency Preparedness Policies and Procedures

It is the policy of the HDS program to maintain care and supervision of our consumers in the event of natural disaster or other large emergency event, until they can safely be released to responsible persons, such as family or caregivers, or first responders such as Fire, Police, Hospital or evacuation shelter personnel when appropriate. To that end, an on-going effort is made to prepare staff and consumers through routine emergency drills; periodic inventory and replenishment of emergency supplies; and administrative review of compliance/areas in need of improvement.

Staff Review of Policiesrrrainiig on Procedures

1. Maintain care and safety of consumers in the event of natural disaster or large emergency event.
 - A. How long should we continue to care for clients in the event of an emergency?
 - Until they can be safely released to responsible persons, i.e. family and caregivers, first responders, or evacuation shelter.
 - An ortgoing effort will be made to prepare staff and clients through routine emergency drills.
2. We are required to conduct annual one-hours in-service training on emergency preparedness.
 - A. Disaster response plan policy
 - B. Emergency preparedness drills.

Emergency PreDaredness Drills. Emergency drills will be performed at minimum every six months, with one drill specifically focused on responding to a major earthquake. Each staff member will be given the "Emergency Drill Preparation" form to guide their group's preparation for a drill. The form contains an ability assessment to rate each consumer's basic understanding of how to respond to a particular emergency type, and their ability to demonstrate how to get to a protected position. On the back of the form is "Responding to Emergencies: Some Basic Rules", that describes initial protective actions to take in the event of fire, earthquake, car accident or breakdown (the "Show Me" section).

For example, when staff prepare to do an earthquake drill, they will discuss with their consumers the "rules" for responding to an earthquake (e.g., DROP/COVER /HOLD ON). Staff will demonstrate DROP/COVER/HOLD ON, and ask each consumer to also rehearse DROP/COVER/HOLD ON. Research has shown that rehearsal of the skills needed to protect oneself makes it more likely that you will use those skills in an actual emergency. Adaptations for mobility-restricted individuals will be reviewed as needed.

On the "Emergency Drill Preparation" form, staff will rate each consumer's ability to understand the "rules" discussed, as well as their ability to verbalize and/or demonstrate what protective skills are called for in the event of an earthquake. Consumers will also be rated on their ability to locate their personal "emergency pack" (see below, under Emergency Supplies) or I.Dicontact information placed in their wallet and hand it to someone who has asked for their emergency contacts. This information will be reviewed by HDS administrative staff to identify which consumers may require additional support or training to respond effectively to an emergency.

Staff will perform an emergency drill and complete an "Emergency Drill" form to document the results of the drill. The form also asks that they inventory the emergency supplies in their car and each consumers' personal supplies, in order to identify items missing or in need of replacement. HDS administrative staff will review the drill report to identify which staff or consumers need supplies, and make arrangements to obtain those supplies as soon as possible.

3. Emergency Preparedness Drills--

- A. Should be performed at a minimum every six months—one drill must be an earthquake drill
- B. Emergency Drill Preparation — is used to guide each group's preparation for a drill and assesses each client's basic understanding of how to respond to a particular emergency type. This also contains some basic rules under the "Responding to Emergencies: Some Basic Rules"
 - Discuss rules for the given emergency.
 - Staff demonstrate the rules (i.e. DROP/COVER/HOLD on)
 - Participants rehearse the rules.
 - Staff will rate each individual's ability to understand the "rules" as well as their ability to verbalize and demonstrate the rules.
 - Participants will also be rated on their ability to locate their personal "emergency pack"
- C. What is in the client emergency pack? Optional
 - Refillable water bottle
 - Lunch/and or snacks
 - Personal entertainment items (magazines, radio, cell phones)
 - Hygiene items as appropriate (diapers, wipes, sanitary napkins)
 - Additional clothing as appropriate.
 - Copy of face sheet/Medical consent in zip lock
 - One Day of medication
- D. Staff emergency pack
 - What is in the Staff emergency Pack
 - Fully charged cell phone
 - HDS business cards
 - Facesheets/medical consent
 - Other supplies
 - First aid kits
 - Minimum of one gallon of water
 - Emergency snacks
 - Battery powered flashlight
 - Fire extinguisher

Emergency Locations. Given that HDS services are community based, staff will use available resources to seek shelter, supplies and support while they determine how best to safely transport consumers to their care providers at home or (if unsafe to do so) to a local evacuation center. Community centers, senior centers, city halls, libraries, Police and Fire stations, churches and schools, shopping mall security stations, transit centers, etc., are locations that are prevalent, familiar to staff and consumers, and are likely to contain trained personnel (often with radio contact to first responders) that can share information and resources.

4. Emergency locations

- A. Use available resources to seek shelter, supplies and support while determining how to safely transport clients to their care providers or to local Emergency Operation Centers (EOC)
 - Libraries, police departments, fire stations, community centers, senior centers, city halls, churches and schools, security stations, and transit centers are a few of the resources that contain trained personnel that can be used for additional information.
 - Emergency Operation Centers (EOC)
 - Activated in West Covina when an incident off us I west Covina may be expected to require outside resources for mitigation
 - An incident has occurred outside of our jurisdiction that bears monitoring in anticipation of affecting our city.
 - What is the function of the EOC?
 - Provides support for field operations by locating and allocating additional resources and by anticipating future needs as an incident unfolds while maintaining a continual "situation status". Provides a formal communication link between the community and emergency operations on other communities. EOC began the documentation, and coordination necessary to insure the recovery of eligible funding reimbursement from the state FEMA.

Practical tips for responding to earthquakes or other Major emergencies while at work.

1. Before an Emergency Event Occurs.
 - a. Who does the client stay with if the primary caregiver is not available?
 - b. Groups homes should identify an evacuation site if the home is seriously damaged. Ask the group home to provide you with this information.
 2. Assess the Emergency Event
 - a. Check the news frequently
 - b. If aware of an event, determine how close and how severe the situation is
 - c. If you have yet to report to work, and suspect that there is an event close by, do not pick up clients until you have more information to do so.
 - d. Contact the Program Administrator or Supervisors for more info.
 3. Clients in your care during an emergency
 - a. Direct clients to use the protective skills learned and practiced during emergency drills. Check for injuries, seek community support
 - b. If there is an emergency and able to transport the client safely, go to the nearest emergency room
 - c. If it is safer to stay off of the streets, call the caregiver directly and arrange for the client to be taken home. Contact the program administrator or a supervisor to report the status.
 4. There are four types of emergency drills covered on the emergency drill preparation sheet. This can be broken down into "what can clients do?" and "What can Job Coaches do"
 - A. Fire
 - If you hear a smoke alarm, smell fire/smoke, exit the building ASAP
 - If there is a lot of smoke and heat what should you do?
 - Cover your face with a wet shirt and crawl to the exit.
 - How should you touch a door to feel for heat before opening it?
 - With the back of the hand because there could be a fire on the other side and it will burn your skin.
 - What should you do if your clothes catch fire?
 - STOP — DROP — ROLL — to put out the flames
 - What should you look for as you are exiting the building?
 - Fire extinguisher
 - B. Quake
 - What should you do in the event of an EARTHQUAKE
 - DROP—COVER—HOLD ON.
 - What should you cover in an earthquake?
 - Your head with your arms
- When is it safe to get up and check the area?
- When the earthquake is over.
 - If you are outside, what should you do?
 - Move away from buildings, powerlines, trees, and sit down to avoid falling.
 - Check for injuries and provide first aid once you're in a safe location.
 - What should you keep in your car in the event of an earthquake or emergency
 - Water bottles, first aid kit, non-cook foods (Granola Bars), battery powered radio.
 - When should you call 911 after an Earthquake?
 - When someone is seriously injured and requires medical attention. Remember that emergency service vehicles are going to be very busy after an earthquake.
- C. Car-break down
 - If your car breaks down on the road what should you do?
 - Stay safe in the car with the seatbelt fastened, until the driver says it is safe to exit.
 - When exiting the car on the road, what should you do?
 - Move away from the street and move traffic.
 - Who should you call when your car is broken down?
 - Road side assistance and HDS office once everyone is safely out of the car.
 - D. Car Accident
 - First thing that you do if you are in a car accident?

- Check for injuries, if injured in the car, wait for paramedics to come and help.
- Should you help an injured person outside of the vehicle?
 - DON'T MOVE AN INJURED PERSON UNLESS THEY ARE IN DANGER STAYING WHERE THEY ARE IN THE CAR.
 - What can be a danger in the car?
- a. Fire, smell of gas,
 - Call 911 or get the attention of others and tell them to call.
 - What should you do with an injured person in a car?
 - Assist injured person to stop bleeding/keep breathing until help arrives.

Consumer daypack/tote bag. HDS routinely recommends that consumers and their care providers prepare a personal daypack, tote bag or large purse that they bring to a program that contains a refillable water bottle, their lunch and/or snacks, and personal entertainment items (magazines, radio, cell phone, etc.). Hygiene items (diapers, wipes, sanitary napkins) and additional clothing items are included as appropriate to consumer needs.

HDS staff will place a folded copy of the consumer's face sheet/consent for medical treatment inside of a zip-lock plastic bag ("emergency pack"). Care providers will be asked to provide one day's worth of medications preferably in pharmacy labeled childproof containers for program use in case of emergency. Such medications would ideally fit into the "emergency pack" along with the face sheet/consent for medical treatment, and be secured inside of a daypack/tote bag zippered pocket.

Consumers are encouraged to carry their own daypack/tote bag with them as much as possible, especially when using public transportation. If a consumer repeatedly refuses to use a daypack/tote bag, or there are good reasons not to do so (for example, a tendency to lose things) the "emergency pack" may be carried by the Job Coach in their daypack.

Capable consumers may opt to carry I.D., medical information and emergency contact numbers on a card in their wallet, rather than carry a face sheet. Those who carry a personal cell phone will be encouraged to enter their own "ICE" (In Case of Emergency) contact phone number, as well as phone numbers for the HDS office, their Job Coach's work cell number, and other emergency contacts.

If the request for one day's worth of prescribed medications is repeatedly ignored or formally refused by the consumer's care provider, this will be documented in a letter and sent to the service coordinator within 60 days of the initial request by the program.

Staff daypack/tote bag. Staff are required to carry a fully-charged program issued cell phone, HDS office business cards and a duplicate "emergency pack" containing face sheets for assigned and substitute consumers, as well as consumer medications (when necessary) in their personal daypack, tote bag or purse while they are involved in program activities in the community.

Emergency Supplies/Equipment. Each HDS staff assigned to provide consumer care is required to maintain basic emergency supplies that are kept in the staff vehicle, as well as carried on the person of each member of a program group. These supplies are intended to meet the immediate needs of consumers and staff during the first 24 hours after a major disaster while an effort is made to transport consumers home or (if determined unsafe to do so) to a local evacuation center, where additional supplies and support can be accessed.

Other supplies. Staff are required to keep in their passenger car trunk the following supplies: a first aid kit, a minimum of one gallon of drinking water, emergency snack foods (energy/granola bars), a battery powered flashlight, auto fire extinguisher, and a local map. These supplies are purchased by the program, and will be inventoried by administrative staff during vehicle checks twice a year and by direct care staff in preparation for an emergency drill twice a year.

Communication with Care Providers. HDS staff are responsible to contact their assigned consumers' care providers or other designated emergency contacts directly by cell phone as soon as possible after a major

emergency to coordinate how best to return the consumer to their care. For emergency purposes HDS staff may provide their work cell phone number to care providers, and program the work cell phone with care provider cell phone numbers for efficiency. (When phone service is overloaded or otherwise disrupted, text messaging sometimes can connect, which is the reason cell numbers are preferable in an emergency to landline phone numbers.) The "Disaster Response Plan" policy will be given to care providers immediately after HDS conducts its annual in-service training on the subject.